



elongated finger bones support wing membrane

Vampire bat

Desmodus rotundus

As its name suggests, the common vampire bat feeds on blood, mainly of mammals such as tapirs, peccaries, agoutis, and sea lions along with domesticated species such as cattle and horses. Two other species of vampire bat, also living in Central and South America, feed predominantly on bird blood. The common vampire bat can crawl over the ground with amazing speed and agility, propped on its forearms and back legs. It usually lands close to a resting animal and uses its heat-sensitive nose pad to seek areas of warm blood vessels close to the skin. Once bitten, the anticoagulant properties of the bat's saliva help to keep the victim's blood flowing freely.

Reciprocal regurgitation

The common vampire bat has a communal roost in a hollow tree, cave, mine, or old building, which it shares with hundreds of others. Not only will adult females regurgitate blood to their offspring, they also share blood with hungry roost mates. Bats are more likely to help one another if they are related or have roosted together for a substantial amount of time. To judge whether a fellow bat is hungry, they engage in mutual grooming sessions that allow them to feel how distended each others' stomachs are before regurgitating.

↕ 3–4 in (7.6–10 cm)

⚖️ 5⁄8–2 oz (19–57 g)

⊗ Common

🩸 Blood

🏠

Central to South America

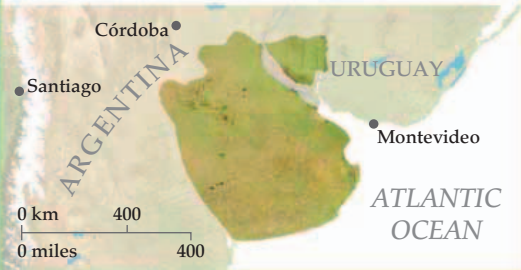
▽ **BLOOD LICKER**
The vampire bat's razor sharp teeth, long tongue, grooved chin, and short nose are all adaptations for getting access to and lapping up blood.



A vampire bat can **drink 50 percent of its body weight** in 30 minutes

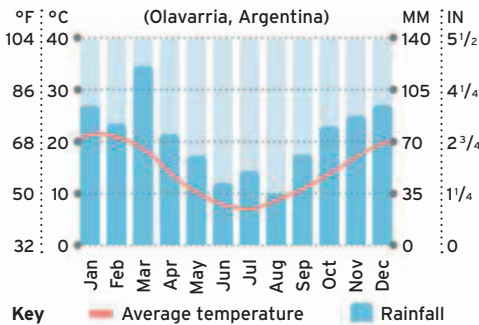
LOCATION

The pampas covers much of eastern Argentina, most of Uruguay, and the extreme south of Brazil.



CLIMATE

The climate across the pampas is mild and dry. Rainfall is lightest in the winter months of June, July, and August.



grass produces 100,000 seeds

WELCOME SHADE
The Ombu tree's large, umbrellalike canopy provides much needed shade in the pampas, where they are sparsely distributed. The tree's thick, spongy trunk is a natural water reservoir and also makes it fire resistant.

OMBU TREE